

comfortable with it. Apart from the interface, check out the size and weight to make sure it fits in with your requirements. If someone you know already owns the phone, he or she will also be able to tell you about the battery life and its other pros and cons. Some dealers also let you try out a demo piece.

Stick To Your Budget

The market is flooded with all sorts of phones. You may be lured to buy a more expensive phone than you can afford, but resist the temptation! Remember that you will be paying for all the features that the device offers, but it may be a waste if you will not use some of them.

Check The Talk-time

You should always check the talk-time of the phone before buying. Most mobile manufacturers specify this on the packaging box. However, it will be better if you can confirm this from a trusted source, such as a *Digit* review, or from someone you know who owns the same model.

Power Woes

There are usually two types of batteries available in the Indian market: Lithium Polymer and Lithium-ion. While buying a new phone, it's advisable to buy one with a Lithium Polymer battery, as these are slimmer and have a larger power capacity. A third type of battery, Nickel Metal Hydride, was used in older models, but has been mostly discontinued as these are heavier and have less power capacity.

Size, Shape And Weight

It's advisable to opt for a medium-sized phone that easily fits in your pocket. It's easier to hold and use such phones than newer, tiny models, even if the latter look more appealing—especially if you have large hands.

Also check out the weight, as the weight mentioned by the manufacturer could be

without the battery. Some users may prefer to opt for flip models over the standard candy-bar phones.

Scheduling your work

Most phones give you the functionality of a calendar and task options, which allow you to create daily schedules. However, the calendar could prove inconvenient if you are not provided with a monthly view.

Internal Memory

Some basic phones do not give you any internal phonebook memory. High-end phones provide fixed allocated memory ranging from 300 to 500 contacts, and also give you the flexibility of adding

data. If you're buying a high-end phone, it's advisable to buy one that supports external memory so that you can add more when you need. Again, this is important for phones with features that require extra storage.

Colour Display

If your budget permits, buy a phone that provides a colour display—the prices of these phones have come down drastically. The choices range from phones that can display 4K colours, 65K colours, and now even 260K colours. Generally speaking, phones with screens that can display more colours will be more expensive.

Tri-band Or Dual-band

Check if the phone supports dual-band, and

distances. If your phone supports Bluetooth, you can also use a Bluetooth headset in most cases.

The advantage of Bluetooth over infrared is that apart from being faster and having more range, Bluetooth does not require line-of-sight, as is the case with IR.

Multimedia Messaging Service (MMS)

Most high-end phones have this feature, which allows you to send and receive rich media messages (comprising text, sounds, images and video).

However, most phones have a size restriction per message, and they may not allow you to forward audio. Before buying an MMS-enabled phone, make sure you take into consideration the file size restrictions and its capability to send audio.

Concatenated Messages And Character Support

The GSM standard restricts you to messages containing 160 characters, so a phone that supports concatenated messages enables you to send longer messages. Phones that have support for Unicode will allow you to display blinking messages.

Bundled Accessories

Most expensive phones bundle quite a few accessories in the form of a communications cable, a desktop charger, a leather case, etc. Check for these.

Voice Dial

This is a system that allows you to dial a telephone number by just saying the person's name. Voice dial is convenient, and useful in places where you cannot see the keypad or when your hands aren't free.

OS And Application Support

Most high-end phones allow you to install additional games and applications depending upon the OS and available memory. Options available include Symbian and Series 60.



A Bluetooth handsfree headset has more range than an infrared one

Fuel cell-powered mobile cartridges are good when you're travelling

multiple entries for each contact—such as different phone numbers for home, work, mobile etc.

Hence, before buying a phone, take a look at the amount of internal phone memory that it ships with.

Internal memory is all the more important for phones that have features such as an integrated camera, MP3 playback, voice recording etc, as you will require more memory for storage.

External Memory Support

Many mid-range and high-end phones give you the flexibility of adding external memory modules, which allow you to add more

preferably tri-band, which ensures that you can use the phone globally.

Infrared Port

Most new phones give you lots of connectivity options. Phones with infrared allow for a wireless connection between a computer and the phone. You can use infrared to send and receive phone book entries (business cards), reminder notes, images and much more.

Bluetooth

Bluetooth provides a very user-friendly way of transmitting data at high speeds over short